DECO3500 – Social and Mobile Computing – Design Proposal
Team 25

Enhancing Grocery Choices for UQ Students through Social and Contextual Computing

Our team

Design & Prototyping Lead
James Olbes

Documentation and Theory Lead
Kenan Chu

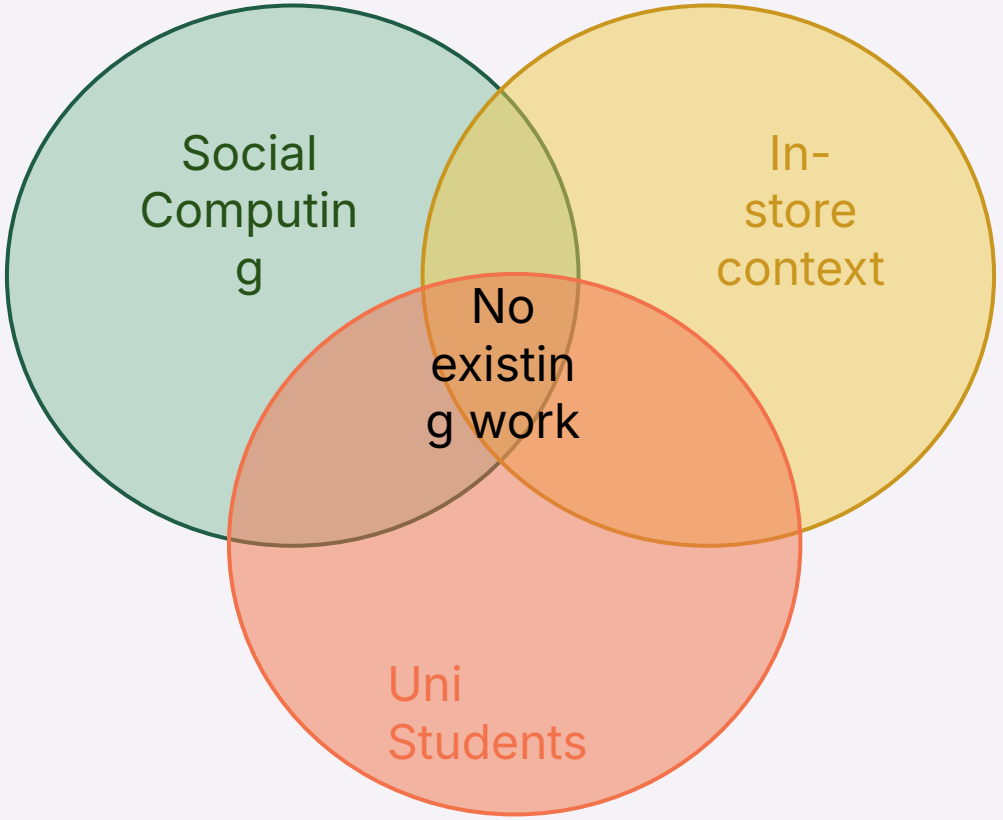
Project Management Lead
Aman Kushwaha

Technical / Dev Lead
Anujitha Fernando

its combined strengths
(not individual bios)

Domain/Problem Space

"We are interested in understanding how **social media influences** the **food choices of younger UQ students when grocery shopping in person around the St Lucia area**, and how social and/or contextual computing could be used to support or influence these choices."



Wait for the interviews

Initial Concepts – Design Opportunity

- Wait for interviews

Our Audience and the Existing Solutions Landscape

Intended audience – beyond demographics

Skills
High variable food literacy, some have experience while some not

Values
Convenience & cost outweigh health in a moment.

Workflows
Shop nearby store/shops. Social media before stores

Priorities
Budget first, time second, health as an ideal

Existing solution and what they miss

Existing solution	Pros	Con
ShoppingCoach	Improves in-store decisions	Individual only, VR only,
Online social comparison nudges	Proven to change food choices	Only online, not in a physical store
Gameful food-literacy apps	Builds nutrition knowledge	Ignores budget, no personalised data
Social media studies	Shows influences on food choices	Most of the time, only influences

Plan of Work – What's next?

What still needs to be found next?

- Which social mechanism (social comparison, people influence, social media inspiration) students describe as the reason they make choices
- Whether budget concerns are compatible with, or in contention with, a social feature layer
- Enough coverage (interview & research) to move from anecdotal to pattern

How we'll investigate it

- Get enough coverage, whether it'd be research or interview,
- Low-fidelity prototype & test
- Thematic analysis
- Weigh interview themes, feasibility and gap strength to pick a more specific direction